A GIFT FOR READERS



Gathering Flowers

A Short Guide to Florilegia

The ancient monastic reading practice, step by step—with a guided audio session

GIDEON GRAY

Welcome

You are holding a short guide to a very old way of reading.

Florilegia (say it *flor-ih-LEE-jee-uh*) means gathering flowers. You read a short passage slowly, find the one line that catches you, copy it down by hand, and spend three quiet minutes writing about it. That is the whole practice. It takes about five minutes, and you cannot do it wrong.

What you have

This guide

What florilegia is, the five steps one at a time, a worked example, a practice page, and a thirty-day tracker.

The audio session

Under ten minutes, with music, walking you through a full sitting. After your first listen, you only need the part where the music begins, about five minutes in. The link is in your welcome email.

A good order

1. **Read pages 3 through 6.** A few minutes. That is enough to understand the idea and the steps.
2. **Play the audio once, all the way through.** Sit somewhere quiet, with headphones if you like, and a pen and paper beside you.
3. **Then practice on your own,** every day, as described below.

EVERY DAY AFTER THE FIRST

Choose a new passage from the text you are reading. Read it, find your sparklet, and write it out. Then play the audio and skip ahead to where the music begins, about five minutes in. Those are your three minutes. You never need to hear the whole recording again. Print the thirty daily worksheets that begin on page 14 and use one a day.

You will need: a pen, paper or a notebook (or this guide printed out), a timer, and five minutes without interruption.

What Florilegia Is

The word is a garden word. It comes from the Latin *flos*, a flower, and *legere*, to gather. A florilegium is a gathering of flowers—not real ones, but lines. The phrases that catch you as you read, the ones that shine out of the page and stay with you after you have closed the book, are the blossoms.

Monks and scholars practiced this from roughly the fifth century through the twelfth. It grew out of an older habit called commonplacing: keeping a notebook in which a reader copied the best of what passed before them, so that wisdom met once would not be lost. A monk reading the Psalms or the letters of the Church Fathers would copy out the verses that struck him most deeply and group them under themes such as patience, mercy, and the love of neighbor, until he had built a small private scripture out of other people's words. The flowers were not his. The bouquet was.

What turns the practice into more than note-taking is the second half. Once you have gathered, you read your lines back as one new text. Fragments that came from different places begin to speak to one another, and in the space between them a meaning can appear that was not in either passage alone.

TWO HALVES OF ONE PRACTICE

Gathering: read slowly, notice the line that sparks, copy it down, and write beside it.
Reading back: after many days, read all your gathered lines together as a single text.

Nothing about this belongs to one book. Florilegia works with any text you return to and hold dear: the Psalms, a poem, a letter, a page of ancient scripture, a book you have read a dozen times. Bring whatever you are reading.

What a Sparklet Is

The single line you gather—the one that shines out and asks to be kept—deserves a name of its own. In this guide we call it a **sparklet**.

A sparklet is not the most important line in a passage, or the one you are supposed to underline, or the verse a teacher would test you on. It is the line that sparks for you, today, in the particular life you are living as you read. You do not choose it by argument. You notice which words refuse to let you go, lift them out, and write them down.

It can be any size

A SENTENCE

A whole line that says something you needed to hear.

THREE WORDS

A small phrase that is somehow bigger than its size.

AN IMAGE

A star off its course, a door in the heavens, a name spoken in a dream.

How you know you have one

Small signs give it away. You find yourself rereading the line without meaning to. It pleases you, or bothers you a little. You want to argue with it. You cannot say why it matters, only that it does.

The same passage will hand you a different sparklet a year from now. That is not a flaw in the practice. It is the practice. The text does not change; you do, and the line that sparks changes with you.

That is the quiet promise of florilegia.
Not more information. More room.

The Practice on One Page

About five minutes in all: two to read, find, and copy, and three to gather.

1

READ

Read the passage slowly, twice. Once to meet it, once to listen.

about 1 minute

2

FIND

Notice the line, phrase, or image that sparks. Do not choose by argument. Choose what catches.

about 30 seconds

3

WRITE

Copy your sparklet out by hand, slowly, one word at a time.

about 30 seconds

4

GATHER

Set a timer for three minutes. Write whatever the line stirs. Keep the pen moving.

3 minutes

5

STOP

When the timer stops, close the book. You are done for the day.

You cannot do this wrong.

There are no right sparklets. There is only the one that caught you.

After your first full listen, skip ahead each day to where the music begins, about five minutes in.

The Five Steps

Each one explained: what to do, what it looks like, and what to do if you get stuck.

1 Read slowly, twice

WHAT TO DO

Read the passage through once to meet it. Then read it again, under your breath if you can, listening instead of scanning. The ear catches what the eye skims.

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

It does not look like studying. No dictionary, no commentary. You are walking through a meadow, not surveying it. The passages in this guide are short, so this takes about a minute.

IF YOU GET STUCK

If the language feels strange, and the older translations do, let it be strange. You do not have to understand every word. Stay with whichever parts feel most alive to you, clear or not.

2 Find your sparklet

WHAT TO DO

Notice the single line, phrase, or even the few words that shine out and will not let go. Mark it lightly with a pencil, or just hold it in mind.

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

It can be a whole sentence, three words, or an image. A reader of the passage on page 9 might be caught by “how they do not change their orbits,” or by the single word “steadfast,” or by “dew.”

IF YOU GET STUCK

Nothing sparks. Choose the line you like best, or the one that bothers you a little. Irritation is a spark too.

Everything sparks. Choose the first line that pulled at you. Save the others for another day; they will keep.

You worry it is the wrong line. There is no wrong line. The same passage will give you a different one next month.

The line seems too ordinary. Good. Ordinary lines often hold the most.

3 Write it out by hand

WHAT TO DO

Copy your sparklet onto your page, slowly, one word at a time. The slowness is part of the practice, not a delay before it. The monks copied their flowers letter by letter.

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

A line or two at the top of a clean page. Add the date if you like, and the name of the passage so you can find it again.

IF YOU GET STUCK

If handwriting is hard for you, type it. Still go slowly, and say each word to yourself as you enter it.

4 Gather for three minutes

WHAT TO DO

Set a timer for three minutes. Write whatever the line stirs in you: a memory, a question, an objection, a picture, a name. Do not steer. Let it wander. Keep the pen moving until the timer ends. Or play the audio, skip ahead to where the music begins, and let it hold your time.

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Messy. Sentences left unfinished. A jump from the passage to your grandmother's kitchen to a question about next week. All of that is the practice working. Page 10 shows what three minutes can look like.

IF YOU GET STUCK

Your mind goes blank. Write “I have nothing to say” and keep the pen moving. Something nearly always follows.

You run dry before the timer ends. Write your sparklet again and see what comes after it.

You think you are writing nonsense. Keep going. No one is going to read it.

5 Stop when the timer stops

WHAT TO DO

When the time is up, put the pen down and close the book. You are finished for the day.

WHY IT MATTERS

The brevity is deliberate. A practice that fits into five minutes is a practice you will do again tomorrow, and the power of florilegia comes from returning, not from laboring over any one entry.

Questions people ask

Do I have to believe the text? No. Ancient and sacred texts have been read as scripture, as history, and as literature, often all at once. Bring whatever you bring. The practice only asks that you read slowly and listen.

Can I use a different book? Yes. Florilegia is older than any one book. Try the Psalms, a poem you love, or a passage from a book you return to.

What if I miss a day? Begin again the next day. The thirty days do not have to be consecutive. They only have to add up.

Do I have to share what I write? Never. These pages are yours. Keep them private, or share a line if you want to.

How long should I keep a passage? One sitting is enough. You can return to the same passage another day and find a different flower.

> *Florilegia is a contemplative reading practice. It is not therapy, medical advice, or religious instruction. If something stirs up more than you want to handle alone, set the page down and talk to someone you trust.*

A Worked Example

Following one reader through one short passage.

> 1 ENOCH 2:1–3 · R. H. CHARLES TRANSLATION, 1912
>
> Observe ye everything that takes place in the heaven, how they do not change their orbits, and the luminaries which are in the heaven, how they all rise and set in order each in its season, and transgress not against their appointed order. Behold ye the earth, and give heed to the things which take place upon it from first to last, how steadfast they are, how none of the things upon earth change, but all the works of God appear to you. Behold the summer and the winter, how the whole earth is filled with water, and clouds and dew and rain lie upon it.

STEP 1 · READ

The first time through: stars rising and setting, the seasons turning, rain. Reading it again aloud, I notice how many times someone tells me to look. *Observe. Behold. Behold.* It is almost an insistence.

STEP 2 · FIND

Three lines pull at me: “rise and set in order each in its season,” the word “dew,” and “how steadfast they are.” The third is the one I keep rereading, so that is my sparklet. I highlight it above. I could have chosen either of the others, and tomorrow I might.

STEP 3 · WRITE

I copy it onto a clean page, slowly:

how steadfast they are

Then I set the timer, and turn the page.

Three Minutes, Written

An example of what three minutes can look like, written for this guide. Yours will be different.

how steadfast they are

Steadfast. I don't think I've said that word out loud in years. My mother used it about my grandfather—"steadfast, that man"—meaning he took the same bus to the same job for forty-one years and never once complained. I always heard it as a little sad. But the stars aren't sad about it. They just keep the schedule.

When did I stop believing in any schedule of my own? What would it be to be steadfast about one small thing? Not the job. Not the argument with my sister. One thing. Maybe this. Three minutes, same chair, every day.

Timer's almost up. The dew. I like the dew. It doesn't try.

What to notice

The writing left the passage within a sentence and went to a memory. It asked a question and left it unanswered. It ended unfinished. None of that is a mistake: the line opened a door the reader had not planned to walk through, and nothing on this page needs to be wise.

Your Turn

PRACTICE ENTRY · THE WORKS THAT DO NOT CHANGE

1 ENOCH 5:1–3 · R. H. CHARLES TRANSLATION, 1912

Observe ye how the trees cover themselves with green leaves and bear fruit: wherefore give ye heed and know with regard to all His works, and recognize how He that liveth for ever hath made them so. And all His works go on thus from year to year for ever, and all the tasks which they accomplish for Him, and their tasks change not, but according as God hath ordained so is it done. And behold how the sea and the rivers in like manner accomplish and change not their tasks from His commandments.

Reading cue: notice which of the three you picture first—the trees, the sea, or the rivers.

YOUR SPARKLET

The line that caught you. Write it out by hand.

GATHER · THREE-MINUTE TIMER

What does it stir, recall, or argue with? Follow it wherever it goes.

Date: _____ *Come back later: when you have gathered many sparklets, read them together as one text.*

Going Deeper

Optional. Use any of these, or none.

When you want to go further, or when a particular passage asks for it, try one of these. They are invitations, never requirements.

Read it a third time, aloud, before you choose your sparklet. Hearing the words in your own voice often changes which ones stand out.

Sit in silence for thirty seconds before you begin to write, with the pen resting in your hand. Let the noise of the day settle first.

Date each entry, and note the passage. Months from now, the dates will tell their own story.

Note a question the passage leaves you with, and carry it into the day without trying to answer it.

Let your writing drift toward a horizon

If the free writing needs a direction, you can let it lean toward one of four large questions. Pick one, or let the line pick for you.

YOUR PLACE
in the universe.

YOUR PLACE
in history.

THIS TEXT'S PLACE
in the long story of belief.

THE PLACE OF GOD
however you understand God, in your own life.

Whatever rises, write it. You are not being tested. You are waiting, and tending, and listening.

The Thirty-Day Invitation

This practice rewards repetition more than almost anything else you can do with a book. So the invitation is simple: one passage a day, five minutes at a time, for thirty days. Morning or night, whichever steadies you. Thirty days is long enough for florilegia to turn from something you are trying into something you do.

EVERY DAY AFTER THE FIRST

Choose a new passage, find your sparklet, and write it out. Then play the audio and skip ahead to where the music begins, about five minutes in. The same recording works for all thirty days. Print the daily worksheets that follow (pages 14 through 43) and use one a day. Then jot each sparklet in a box below, even just a word or two.

1	2	3	4	5	6
7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18
19	20	21	22	23	24
25	26	27	28	29	30

Reading it back

When the boxes are full, sit down with your thirty sparklets and read them in one sitting, as one text. Read the flowers you gathered as a small scripture of your own, assembled from other people's words. Listen for what the lines say to one another in the spaces between them, and for what the thirty days of quiet have left in you that was not there before.

That new text will be yours alone. No one else will gather the same flowers, or arrange them in the same order, or hear in them the same voice.

WEEK 1

Day 1

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Begin small. Today's only job is to finish the five steps once.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 1

Day 2

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Read the passage aloud, quietly, before you choose your sparklet.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 1

Day 3

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Before you write, sit in silence for thirty seconds with the pen in your hand.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page

☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 1

Day 4

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Choose a passage you have never read before. Notice how it feels to meet something new.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 1

Day 5

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Let your writing lean toward your place in the universe.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 1

Day 6

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Write the date and where you are sitting. Months from now, you will want to know.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 1

Day 7

Date _____

A MILESTONE

One week. Turn to the tracker on page 13 and read your six earlier sparklets back, one after another. What do they say together?

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 2

Day 8

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Choose the line that bothers you a little. Irritation is a spark too.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 2

Day 9

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Let your writing lean toward your place in history.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 2

Day 10

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Read the passage a third time, aloud, before you choose your sparklet.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 2

Day 11

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

At the end of your three minutes, write your sparklet once more and see if it means something different.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 2

Day 12

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Choose a short passage today: two or three sentences.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 2

Day 13

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Let your writing lean toward the place of this text in the long story of belief.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page

☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 2

Day 14

Date _____

A MILESTONE

Two weeks. Read all thirteen earlier sparklets back. Underline any words that repeat.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 3

Day 15

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Choose a line you disagree with. Write why, without trying to win.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 3

Day 16

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Sit in silence for a full minute before you read. Let the day settle first.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 3

Day 17

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Let your writing lean toward the place of God, however you understand God, in your own life.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 3

Day 18

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Note a question the passage leaves you with, and carry it into the day without trying to answer it.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 3

Day 19

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Copy your sparklet more slowly than feels natural, one word at a time.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 3

Day 20

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Write about the line as if you were explaining it to someone you love.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page

☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 3

Day 21

Date _____

A MILESTONE

Three weeks. Read all twenty earlier sparklets back. Which one would you keep if you could keep only one?

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 4

Day 22

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Return to a passage from earlier in the thirty days. See what sparks this time.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 4

Day 23

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Let the first thing you write be a question instead of a statement.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 4

Day 24

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

If you have been writing only in sentences, try a handful of words, or a small drawing.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 4

Day 25

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Take the passage somewhere new today: a different chair, a porch, a walk before you sit.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 4

Day 26

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Write down one way this practice has changed how you read.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 4

Day 27

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Let your writing lean toward whatever you keep circling back to.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 4

Day 28

Date _____

A MILESTONE

Four weeks. Read all twenty-seven earlier sparklets back in one sitting. Notice the spaces between them.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page

☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 5

Day 29

Date _____

TODAY'S INVITATION (OPTIONAL)

Choose a passage you would like to carry into the next thirty days.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

WEEK 5

Day 30

Date _____

A MILESTONE

The last day. Gather as usual. Then turn to the tracker on page 13 and read all thirty sparklets as one text.

1 READ *slowly, twice*

Passage: book, chapter, verse or page ☐ I read it twice

2 FIND 3 WRITE *the line that caught you, by hand*

4 GATHER *three minutes, pen moving*

5 STOP *close the book; you are done for today*

A question I am carrying (optional)

Where to Go Next

You now have everything the practice needs: five steps, one recording, and thirty days of worksheets. Florilegia asks very little of you, and it grows the longer you keep it.

When your thirty days are done, you can begin again with a new text, or go back to one you have gathered from before and see what it gives you now. Many readers keep the practice going for years with one notebook and the same five steps.

MORE FROM GIDEON GRAY

You can find all of my books on my Amazon author page.

amazon.com/stores/author/B0DZWBX2DQ

Thank you for reading slowly. I hope the practice stays with you.



SOURCES

Passages from 1 Enoch used as examples are from R. H. Charles, trans., *The Book of Enoch* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1912). Public domain.

Florilegia is a contemplative reading practice. It is not therapy, medical advice, or religious instruction.

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